ISPTech Raises €5.5M Seed Round to Redefine How Spacecraft Manoeuvre in Orbit

Join Capital and Final Frontier Back ISPTech to Keep European Satellites Resilient in a Contested Orbit

Stuttgart, Germany - 27 February 2026 - ISPTech, a German space tech company building propulsion systems that let spacecraft freely manoeuvre in orbit, has raised €5.5 million to deploy its advanced, non-toxic propulsion solutions for operational space missions.

The funding comes as demand for easy to use, cost-efficient and scalable propulsion solutions rises sharply. This shift reflects a broader industry transition towards safer, more flexible and more affordable in-orbit mobility, which ISPTech aims to take a defining role.

The round was led by Join Capital, with participation from Final Frontier, High-Tech Gründerfonds (HTGF), Faber, First Momentum Ventures, Lightfield Equity, the German Aerospace Center (DLR), and Start-up BW Seed Fonds, among others. The Seed funding will be used to expand manufacturing capabilities, testing of critical infrastructure and to accelerate commercial deployment.

Satellite constellations are growing denser and missions are becoming more complex as spacecraft must reliably shift orbits and avoid collisions with zero tolerance for failure. With mobility in orbit becoming a hard operational constraint, ISPTech is building propulsion systems which are now ready for spaceflight and accelerating commercial traction with satellite manufacturers and mission operators. The technology also has strong applications across defence, servicing and even refueling.

"In a contested environment, manoeuvrability is survivability. ISPTech gives European satellites the freedom to move, react, and operate independently - and that is the kind of sovereignty that cannot be outsourced."

— Niels Vejrup Carlsen, Founding Partner, Final Frontier

"Regular, reliable and affordable access to space via reusable rockets is possible now. However, the true in-space ecosystem will only be unlocked by mobility solutions for satellites and spacecraft. We are building the propulsion systems that will power the space ecosystem and enable the expansion of humankind into our solar system."

— Dr. Lukas Werling, CEO and Co-Founder, ISPTech

Meanwhile on Earth, regulatory pressure is accelerating the phase-out of conventional propulsion systems that rely on highly toxic propellants. Substances such as hydrazine are facing bans under proposed legislation due to its toxicity and carcinogenicity, which will increase costs and limit flexibility for existing operators. As regulators and launch providers tighten restrictions on these chemicals, satellite manufacturers are being forced to rethink propulsion choices. This is creating demand for alternatives that can meet mission requirements without introducing new operational risk.

Enabling Mobility for Every Spacecraft

As satellite constellations grow denser and missions demand greater manoeuvrability, propulsion has become a critical operational constraint rather than a background subsystem. ISPTech's propulsion portfolio spans HyNOx, an easy-to-use and affordable propulsion system designed for robustness, long continuous firings, and rapid availability, which is an ongoing limitation with competing systems.

"Too much space hardware looks great on paper and never proves itself where it matters, in orbit. Propulsion is foundational to everything that happens in space and needs to be executed without adding risk or complexity under real constraints. ISPTech is doing this today for every class of spacecraft and every mission profile."

— Felix Lauck, CTO and Co-Founder, ISPTech

Its HIP_11 solution is a patented propulsion technology developed as a practical alternative to conventional toxic hypergolic propellants. It uses a unique, self-igniting propellant combination based on hydrogen peroxide and an ionic liquid fuel, offering a drop-in replacement for toxic hypergols without compromising reliability or maneuverability.

Furthermore, this technology allows for the seamless implementation of an electric mode, which enables efficient and fast maneuvers to be performed with the same system. This true multi-mode approach is only possible with HIP_11.

Together, the HyNOx and HIP_11 systems allow ISPTech to supply propulsion for spacecraft ranging from small CubeSats to large satellites, in-orbit service vehicles, and future mission architectures.

Built on more than a decade of propulsion research at the German Aerospace Center (DLR), ISPTech's technologies address persistent challenges that still constrain satellite operators today.

In-Orbit Missions Set for 2026

ISPTech is currently preparing two customer missions, with a first small-sat mission using ISPTech propulsion scheduled to launch in 2026. Furthermore, CubeSat propulsion systems are undergoing acceptance testing, with deliveries planned for later this year.

ISPTech has already secured significant customer contracts for customer missions, reflecting early confidence from spacecraft manufacturers and mission operators.

"Our contract with ISPTech is a testament to the short lead time, the capabilities of their propulsion systems, and the strength of the team behind them."

— Sebastian Klaus, CEO and Co-Founder, Atmos Space Cargo

Development of HIP_11 and orbital refueling capabilities is further supported through projects backed by the European Space Agency, reinforcing the technology's relevance for long-term European space infrastructure.

"Under the leadership of Lukas and Felix, ISPTech is set to enable truly dynamic and flexible space operations, redefining what's possible in orbit with the breakthrough of their multimode chemical/electrical propulsion system. Their combination of deep technical expertise, commercial acumen, and extensive network across the space community is exceptional."

— Julia Flaig, Join Capital

ISPTech is building the mobility layer for the future space economy. Its ambition is to unlock propulsion capabilities that do not yet exist by giving spacecraft the freedom to move, adapt, and operate reliably over long missions. By turning propulsion from a constraint into an enabler, ISPTech is laying the groundwork for resilient satellite operations, new in-orbit services, and a fully functional in-space ecosystem.

About ISPTech

InSpacePropulsion Technologies (ISPTech) is pioneering a new era of space mobility – delivering propulsion solutions for every spacecraft and every mission. As a spin-off from the German Aerospace Center (DLR), the company offers cost-effective, robust and quickly available in-space propulsion solutions based on more than 10 years of R&D. ISPTech's two technologies – HyNOx and HIP_11 – serve every spacecraft from small CubeSats to large landers and capsules.

About Final Frontier

Final Frontier is a Danish venture capital fund investing in European startups specialising in space and defence technologies. Founded in 2024 with €4.5 million in capital under management, the fund focuses on pre-seed and seed-stage investments across the European space and defence value chain. Notable investors include former NATO Secretary General Anders Fogh Rasmussen, who has emphasised that "developing a strong and resilient defence industry requires private capital."

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